Why you should work on btcd

Full node implementation in Go



Water deer. My spirit animal

github.com/kcalvinalvin



Seoul Bitcoin Meetup since 2017

https://www.meetup.com/seoulbitcoin/



github.com/btcsuite/btcd



Main contributions as a developer

https://eprint.iacr.org/2019/611

#5 btcd contributor

Calvin Kim

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Source: github.com/btcsuite/btcd/graphs/contributors, 11 Nov 2026.

100%

btcd is easier to read than any other implementation

"btcd code is so much better than Bitcoin Core's"

roasbeef - CTO of Lightning Labs

cfilters are on by default

Four Bitcoin codebases



Bitcoin Core



rust-bitcoin



libbitcoin



btcd

Names explain the code

Bitcoin Core

```
int nSize = nCompact >> 24;
uint32_t nWord = nCompact & 0x007fffff;
```

rust-bitcoin

```
let unshifted_expt = bits >> 24;
let (mant, expt) = { /* ... */ };
```

libbitcoin
parse fields

```
bool negative;
exponent_type exponent;
small_type mantissa;
```

btcd

```
mantissa := compact & 0x007fffff
isNegative := compact&0x00800000 != 0
exponent := uint(compact >> 24)
```

Why include the input amount?

BIP143 signature hashing

Bitcoin Core

```
// Witness sighashes need
// the amount.
```

rust-bitcoin

```
/// Computes the BIP-0143 sighash
/// to spend a p2wpkh transaction
/// for any flag type.
```

libbitcoin

```
// NOT THREAD SAFE
// Concurrent input validation for a tx
// unsafe due to on-demand hash caching.
```

btcd

```
// This allows offline, or hardware
// wallets to compute the exact amount
// being spent, in addition to the
// final transaction fee.
//
// [...] invalid input amount, the real
// sighash will differ causing
// the produced signature to be invalid.
```

Selected source comments, rewrapped

Errors explain what went wrong

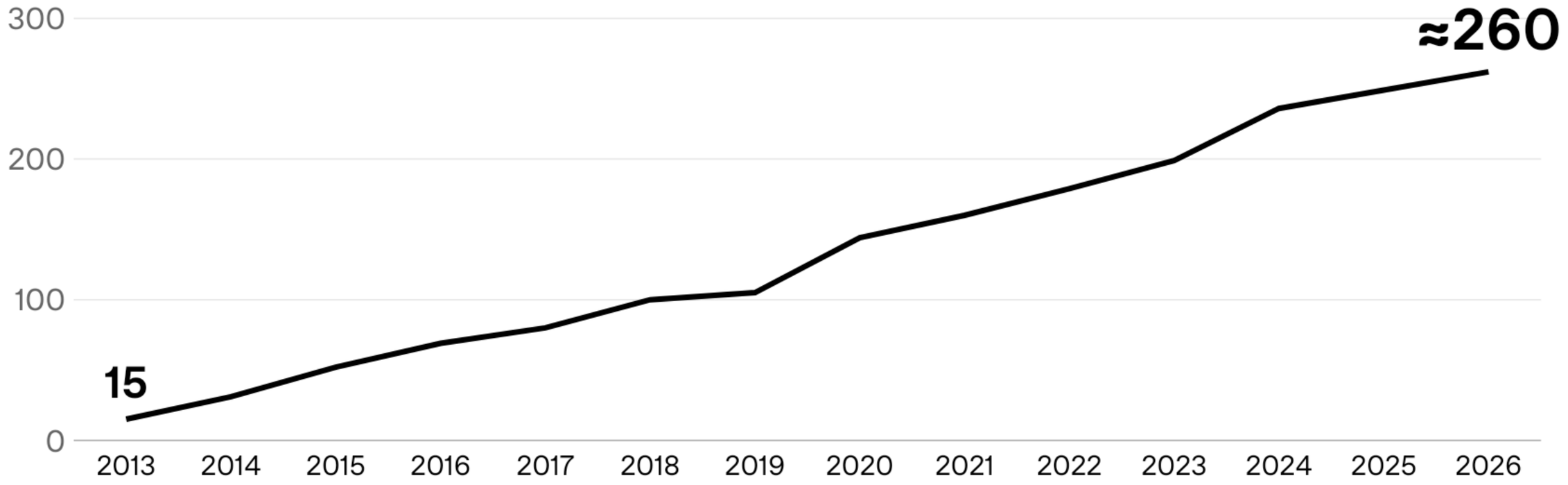
OP_CHECKLOCKTIMEVERIFY: height vs. timestamp

Bitcoin Core	`Locktime requirement not satisfied`
rust-bitcoin via bitcoinconsensus	`bitcoinconsensus error`
libbitcoin	`op_check_locktime_verify3`
btcd	**`mismatched locktime types`** `--` `tx locktime 100, stack locktime 500000000`

Rust uses optional Core bindings (std). Values illustrative. Error strings rewrapped.

btcd contributors

Cumulative commit authors



btcsuite/btcd git history, as of 11 Nov 2026. Aliases combined; counts approximate.

ACTIVE BITCOIN

Built on btcsuite

Active Bitcoin projects



29 ACTIVE CONSUMERS

Verified July 2026

LIGHTNING LABS

- lnd
- Neutrino
- Lightning Terminal
- Loop
- Pool
- Faraday
- Aperture
- lndmon
- chantools
- lndinit
- Wavelength
- lightning-onion
- Node Connect
- lndclient
- lseed

INDEPENDENT PROJECTS

WALLETS + HARDWARE

- Muun
- Alby Hub
- BitBoxApp
- Bold Wallet
- SeedHammer

LAYERS + MINING

- arkd
- Spark
- Proto Fleet
- Pogolo

INFRASTRUCTURE + TOOLS

- utreexod
- Scaling Lightning
- Breez LSP
- Bitonic BIP322
- SeedEtcher



How you can contribute

Review pull requests

Add tests, especially **netsync**

Submit new feature PRs

